

SITE VALIDATION CHECKLIST

A practical guide to evaluating high-potential convenience store locations.

1. Location & Visibility

- ☐ **High Traffic Volume**
Is the site located on a high-traffic arterial road (check local DOT traffic counts)?
- ☐ **Clear Line of Sight**
Is the store clearly visible to passing traffic from at least 300-500 feet away?
- ☐ **Signage Opportunities**
Does the local zoning permit prominent monument or pylon signs?
- ☐ **Morning Side of the Road**
Is the site on the "going-to-work" side of the road? (Crucial for morning coffee/breakfast traffic)

2. Accessibility & Ingress/Egress

- ☐ **Easy Entry and Exit**
Are there multiple curb cuts allowing for smooth entry and exit without tight turns?
- ☐ **Corner Location or Signalized Intersection**
Is it at a hard corner or controlled by a traffic light to help drivers exit left?
- ☐ **Ample Parking Space**
Can the lot accommodate a minimum of 10-15 parking spaces comfortably?
- ☐ **Delivery Truck Access**
Is there enough turning radius and space for vendor and fuel delivery trucks (if applicable)?

3. Demographics & Trade Area

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Dense Population Base

Is there a sufficient residential population within a 1 to 3-mile radius?

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Target Income Levels

Does the median household income in the immediate area align with your pricing strategy?

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Local Traffic Drivers

Are there nearby schools, hospitals, office parks, or industrial centers that drive daily footfall?

4. Competition & Market Dynamics

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Competitor Proximity

Are existing competitors far enough away, or do they have weaknesses you can exploit?

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Market Saturation

Is there an unmet need in the area (e.g., lack of fresh food, modern facilities, or specific fuel types)?

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Future Developments

Are there planned road changes or new commercial developments that could positively or negatively impact the site?

5. Physical & Regulatory Feasibility

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Lot Size & Topography

Is the lot size at least 0.75 - 1.5 acres (depending on fuel offering) and relatively flat?

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Zoning Approvals

Is the property currently zoned for retail/commercial use, including fuel and alcohol sales if planned?

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Environmental Clearances

Has a Phase 1 Environmental Site Assessment (ESA) been conducted and cleared?

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Utilities Availability

Are water, sewer, electricity, and high-speed internet readily available at the site?

Additional Notes / Action Items:

Prepared for Your Success. Use this checklist as a preliminary tool to filter high-potential locations before conducting full feasibility studies.